SHIELD (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 1 – Abjuration
Casting Time: **Reaction**, which you take when you are hit by an attack roll or targeted by *Magic Missile* · Range: Self
Components: V, S · Duration: 1 round
Classes: Sorcerer, Wizard

An imperceptible barrier of magical force protects you. Until the start of your next turn, you have a **+5 bonus to AC**, including against the triggering attack, and you take **no damage from *Magic Missile***.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. An attack hits you (or you are targeted by Magic Missile): you use your **Reaction**.
2. +5 to AC until the start of your next turn.
3. The triggering attack may now miss.
4. Magic Missile deals you no damage.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say whether you know the attack roll before reacting. Fix: the DM announces before the game that you can react **after** seeing the roll's result, but before damage.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a flash of light materializing in front of the caster and deflecting the blow.

Step 1 – Trigger:

An attack hits you, or *Magic Missile* targets you. Your Reaction must be available.

Step 2 – Cast Shield:

Components V, S. You spend a level 1 or higher slot.

Step 3 – Effect:

+5 to AC until the start of your next turn. The triggering attack is compared to the new AC.

Step 4 – Result:

If the attack roll is lower than the new AC, the attack misses. Magic Missile deals you no damage.

Example: Eliot (AC 12) is hit by a bandit who rolled 15. He casts Shield: AC 17. 15 is lower than 17: the attack misses. Until the start of his turn, his AC stays 17.

SHIELD (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

When can I cast it?
When an attack hits you or Magic Missile targets you.

How long does it last?
Until the start of your next turn.

Does it protect against the attack that hit me?
Yes: the +5 applies to that attack.

Does it negate Magic Missile?
Yes: you take no damage from it.

Does it protect against spells with saves?
No: the +5 applies to AC only.

What action does it use?
Your Reaction.

Can I cast it if I already used my Reaction?
No.

Does it stack with a shield?
Yes: it's a bonus to AC. Table rule

⚠ Debate points and table options:
Table rule

Reacting after the roll
The trigger is "being hit". **Option**: the DM announces the roll; or only says "hit / miss".

Critical Hits
A Critical Hit always hits. **Option**: Shield can't prevent it; or it does if the total roll is lower than the new AC.

One Reaction
Shield and *Counterspell* use the same Reaction. **Option**: one Reaction per round, as the rules say.

Multiple attacks
The +5 lasts until the start of your next turn: it also covers later attacks. **Option**: keep it.

Automatic effects
The spell only protects against "attack" and Magic Missile. **Option**: no effect on saving throws.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Reaction during your turn
You can cast Shield during your turn, but you expend only one spell slot per turn.

Shield item and spell
Attacking with a shield doesn't remove its AC bonus. The Shield spell and the shield item are two different things.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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